VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

CSE0001 — Digital Literacy

Project Report

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1. Introduction

This report is submitted as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The course is a one-credit non-CGPA subject for all first year B.Tech students. The project asked us to act as Student Digital Ambassadors and build a Digital Literacy Portfolio that covers five different modules.

The five tasks cover creating an infographic, building a professional online presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, writing professional emails, and studying cybercrime awareness. I have completed all five tasks and organised all the files in a GitHub repository. This report explains what I did in each task, which tools I used, and what I learned from the experience.

Module 1 | 20 Marks	Task: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic *Tool Used: Canva*

2. Task 1 — Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task I had to create a one page infographic that explains digital literacy to my batchmates. I used Canva for this because it is free and has a lot of ready made templates that are easy to edit. I had never used Canva before this assignment so it took me some time to figure out how things work but eventually I got comfortable with it.

I chose to cover three topics in my infographic. The first topic explains what digital literacy is — the ability to use digital tools and the internet safely and responsibly. The second topic covers useful digital tools for students:

- GitHub — Code hosting and version control
- Google Forms — Surveys and quizzes
- LinkedIn — Professional networking
- Canva — Graphic design
- HackerRank — Coding practice

The third topic covers safe internet practices such as using strong passwords, enabling two-factor authentication, and never clicking on unknown links or sharing OTPs.

The hardest part was making it look clean without putting too much text on one page. I found it interesting that a simple visual can explain something much faster than a paragraph of writing. The final infographic was exported as a PNG file and uploaded to the task-1-presentation folder in my GitHub repository.

3. Task 2 — Student Digital Portfolio

For this task I had to create accounts on at least three professional platforms and set them up properly. I chose GitHub, LinkedIn and Kaggle because these are the three platforms that I think will be most useful for me during my engineering degree.

GitHub

I already had an account from the project setup but I also created a special profile README repository which shows my name, branch, year and what I hope to learn. I did not know that GitHub had this feature before this assignment.

LinkedIn

I created a new account and filled in the Education section with my degree, college name and expected graduation year of 2029. I kept the profile minimal as suggested in the assignment brief.

Kaggle

I created an account and set up my basic profile with my name and college. Kaggle is a platform for data science and machine learning which I plan to use in my later years when I study those subjects.

I took screenshots of all three profiles and uploaded them to the task-2-portfolio folder. Over the next four years I plan to keep updating these profiles with my projects, certifications and internship experiences.

4. Task 3 — Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Task 3 had two parts. Part A was to complete a coding challenge on HackerRank and Part B was to create a Google Form quiz. I completed both parts.

Part A — HackerRank Coding Challenge

For Part A I created a HackerRank account and completed the Solve Me First challenge. The problem was to write a function that adds two numbers and returns the result. I used Python to solve it. The solution was just one line of code but it was my first time submitting code on an online judge platform and seeing the green passed result was satisfying. I plan to keep practising on HackerRank as I learn more programming in college.

Part B — Google Forms Quiz

For Part B I created a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz on Google Forms. The quiz has four multiple choice questions about digital literacy, phishing, safe internet practices and professional platforms. The fifth question is a short answer question about why strong passwords are important. I linked the form to a Google Sheet so that responses get collected automatically. Both tools are very useful for academic work and I will definitely use them for group projects and data collection in the future.

5. Task 4 — Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

For this task I wrote two professional emails and created a social media checklist. Before this task I had never written a formal email to a professor or a company so this was quite a new experience for me.

The first email was from a student to a professor requesting an extension on an assignment deadline. The second email was from a student to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer internship.

I learned that a good professional email should have:

- A clear and specific subject line
- A proper and respectful greeting
- A short, clear and well-structured body
- A formal sign-off with your full name and details

For the social media checklist I made a list of five do's and five don'ts for college students. I also wrote about a real world example of poor digital communication. A student once posted a negative comment about their professor publicly on social media using their real name. The post went viral and the student faced disciplinary action from the college. This could have been avoided by simply emailing the professor privately. This example made me realise that whatever we post online stays there and can have serious consequences.

6. Task 5 — Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

For this task I chose UPI and Online Payment Fraud as my cybercrime topic. I chose this because it is very common in India and it directly affects college students who use apps like Google Pay, PhonePe and Paytm almost every day.

While researching this topic the most surprising thing I found was how professional and convincing these scammers are. They call people pretending to be from the bank or from UPI customer support and they use very technical sounding language to confuse the victim. I was surprised to know that even people who are educated and careful can fall for these scams. I also did not know that once money is sent via UPI it is almost impossible to get it back, which makes it very important to be careful before making any payment.

After doing this research I have decided to change one habit — I will never share my UPI PIN or OTP with anyone no matter who they claim to be. I will also double check the UPI ID before sending money to anyone.

I have written a detailed case study and a prevention checklist with ten tips including two UPI-specific safety tips. The checklist also mentions:

- National Cyber Crime Portal — cybercrime.gov.in
- Helpline Number — 1930 (available 24 hours a day)

7. Conclusion

This project was different from regular exams because it involved actually doing things rather than just reading about them. I set up real accounts, created real files, built a real quiz and organised everything in a proper GitHub repository. These are skills I will actually use throughout my engineering degree and after graduation.

The task I found most useful was Task 2 because setting up GitHub, LinkedIn and Kaggle early gives me a proper digital identity that I can keep building over the next four years. The task I found most eye-opening was Task 5 because I did not realise how common and dangerous online fraud is in India, especially for young people.

Overall this project taught me that digital literacy is not about knowing how to use a phone or laptop. It is about knowing how to use digital tools safely, professionally and responsibly. I am glad this was included as part of my first year curriculum.

8. References

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5. HackerRank — Coding Practice — *hackerrank.com*
6. Google Forms — Quiz and Survey Tool — *forms.google.com*
7. National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal — *cybercrime.gov.in*
8. Cyber Crime Helpline — 1930 (24x7)
9. VIT Bhopal University — *vitbhopal.ac.in*